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ASSEMBLY - Democrats holding ground in goal to keep L.A. County blue

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Here's a look at early results for the California state Assembly races that touch Los Angeles County on Tuesday:

District 36: Incumbent Republican Tom Lackey took a commanding early lead. Democrats Steve Fox and Johnathon Ervin trailed Lackey, but led Lourdes Everett, Diedra Greenaway and Ollie M. McCaulley in a district that spreads over three counties, including Antelope Valley, Lancaster and Palmdale.

District 38: With Democrat Christy Smith running for former Rep. Katie Hill's seat in Congress, four newcomers — Republicans Suzette Martinez Valladares and Luci Volotzky and Democrats Annie Cho, Kelvin Driscoll, Brandii Grace and Dina Cervantes — competed for this Northern LA County/Ventura County post. Four of the seven candidates had double digit percentages in early returns in the race. Valladares was leading the pack, with Volotzky a strong second. Cho and Driscoll led the Democrats, but were trailing the two Republicans.

District 39: Luz Rivas, the Democratic incumbent in the San Fernando Valley seat, met an old foe in Republican Ricardo Benitez. In early returns, Rivas has more than double the number of votes cast for Benitez.

District 41: Democrat incumbent Chris Holden faced Republican Robin Hvidston in this San Gabriel Valley race. The incumbent took a significant lead with mail-in ballots counted.

District 43: In this district that includes Burbank, Glendale and La Cañada Flintridge, Democrat incumbent Laura Friedman took on Republican Mike Graves and Independent Robert Sexton. The incumbent jumped to an early lead, doubling the number of votes of her two opponents combined.

District 44: Jacqui Irwin aimed to fend off Republican Denise Pedrow for this Oxnard/Thousand Oaks seat. But when the first returns were reported, the race was a virtual dead heat — Irwin had a three-vote lead.

District 45: San Fernando Valley-based Democratic incumbent Jesse Gabriel ran unopposed.

District 46: San Fernando Valley Democrat Adrin Nazarian faced another Democrat, Lanira Murphy. Nazarian is the incumbent, and took a large lead in the early returns.

District 48: Democrat incumbent Blanca Rubio ran unopposed in this district that includes Azusa, Baldwin Park, Covina, Duarte, El Monte, Glendora and Irwindale.

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